

manifesto of
progressive
caprica

A Platform of
Liberalism,
Reform, and
Progress



**We Can Make a Freer and
Fairer Nation, Together.**

PREAMBLE

We, the citizens of Caprica, stand at a crossroads. The institutions that were meant to serve us have grown corrupt, indifferent, and captured by narrow interests. The constitution we inherited is riddled with loopholes exploited by those who mistake power for mandate. The promises of previous governments ring hollow in the streets of our cities and the villages of our regions.

Progressive Caprica was not born of comfort. It was born of necessity - as a rational answer to the failures of the establishment. We are the party of the trade unionist and the petite bourgeoisie, of the soldier who serves the people and the intellectual who illuminates their path, of the regionalist who loves their land but does not mistake it for the nation.

We believe in reason, in the sovereignty of the citizen, in the subordination of privilege to merit and of capital to the common good. We believe that good intentions without results are not virtue, they are vanity.

Every policy we propose, every institution we reform, every public coin we spend must be measured against the standard of real, demonstrable benefit to the people of Caprica.

We are committed to the protection of civil and human rights, civic participation, democratic governance, a sustainable future, and a free market. We are a party of centrists, liberals, environmentalists, and other political traditions united under a banner of fighting for a fairer Caprica.

I. THE STATE

The Second Republic has exhausted itself. Its constitution, a document of compromises that served their moment but have since calcified into instruments of obstruction, must be replaced.

The Progressives call for a constitutional convention empowered to draft the founding document of Caprica's Third Republic - a constitution written in clarity, sealed in democratic legitimacy, and free of the loopholes that oligarchs and obstructionists have exploited for generations.

Parliamentary Government

We reaffirm the parliamentary model as the correct form of republican government. The executive derives its legitimacy from the confidence of the elected Parliament and answers to it. The Prime Minister governs; the Parliament and President holds it to account; the people decide.

When Caprica abolished the Senate, they sent a signal that the people want a legislature that truly represents them.

Cooperative Federalism

Caprica is a nation of regions, each with its own character, history, and civic tradition. Progressive Caprica respects this diversity without surrendering to fragmentation. On the model of cooperative federalism, where regional governments hold meaningful competencies in culture, local administration, and regional development

Rule of Law and Anti-Corruption

The Republic of Virtue begins with honesty. Every elected official and minister under a Progressive government shall be required to publicly declare all assets upon taking office and upon leaving it. There shall be no exceptions and no exemptions.

Lobbying on behalf of foreign interests shall be prohibited. The Caprican state serves Caprican citizens - foreign powers do not buy access to our legislature or our ministries.

An independent judiciary, insulated from political interference, is not negotiable. Judicial appointments shall be made through transparent, merit-based processes overseen by an independent judicial council. The courts serve the law, not the government of the day.

Strengthening Human Rights via The Constitution

The conservatives have gone on a tour of limiting human rights in the last 4 years of our democracy. We will not let them continue it anymore.

In the last few years the right told our people that; abortion restrictions are fine, the people can do it without cannabis, and that harsh immigration restrictions are necessary.

To that, we say: **NO!**

II. ECONOMY: GROWTH AND ORDER

It is necessary that Caprica is guided by those who simultaneously desire economic stability while also wanting an economy that serves the people instead of the interests of corporations. We have a vision for reform.

Taxation: Pay What You Owe, Keep What You Earn

Our tax system will reward contribution and ensure that activities imposing costs on society are appropriately taxed. We will keep inflation and economic prosperity in place with working institutions.

We will expand a fairer Land Value Tax with brakes for higher density houses and upward development to improve land use, raise density and make Caprica more efficient.

We will restore the Motor Vehicle Tax and create a simpler, fairer and more sustainable tax system for Caprica.

Taxes on emissions, fuel, sugar and other harmful products will be indexed to inflation, with sugar and harmful products taxed through continuous excise tax functions that better reflect their social costs.

All these new economic policies will help fuel the new Caprican rejuvenation efforts. The first priority will be balancing the budget. The remainder will be used to subsidize new nuclear buildouts, solar panels and SVF's as well as the strengthening of Caprican social institutions.

Essential Services for The Public Good

Utilities, transport, education, and healthcare are not assets that should be first and foremost in service of profit. They are essential services for the public good.

Private enterprise's primary goal when wading into the sector of essential services should be the benefit of Caprican citizens instead of the benefit of their own corporations. Only through strong regulation, environmental goals, and taxing can this be ensured.

Healthcare, transport, and education should all be under public ownership.

III. SOCIAL POLICY: LIBERTY, EQUALITY, SOLIDARITY

Progressive Caprica is a party of individual liberty and social solidarity - understanding these not as opposites but as complements. A citizen who is hungry is not free. A citizen who is silenced is not equal. A citizen who is left behind is not a partner in the republic but a casualty of it.

Civil Liberties and Freedom of Expression

Free expression is the oxygen of a republic. Progressive Caprica guarantees the right of every Caprican to speak, to publish, to assemble, and to organise without fear of state suppression. We believe in the open marketplace of ideas and the power of democratic debate to distinguish truth from falsehood.

However, liberty is not a shield for those who would destroy the republic that grants it. Speech that organises, incites, or advocates for extremist movements that seek to undermine the constitutional order and democratic foundations of Caprica is not protected expression. It is a threat - and it will be treated as one.

Equality Before the Law

Every Caprican citizen, regardless of sex, sexuality, gender identity, ethnicity, religion, or region, stands equal before the law and equal in the dignity afforded to them by the republic. Progressive Caprica will legislate to close every gap in equality protections and enforce those protections without compromise. We stand with the LGBTQ+ community of Caprica without reservation, without qualification, and without apology. Every legal right, every protection, and every recognition that the law can afford - it shall. On this there is no negotiation.

Gender Equality

Women in Caprica have borne too long the weight of structural inequality. Progressive Caprica commits to equal pay enforcement, equal representation in public institutions, and targeted support measures that acknowledge the specific barriers women face in civic, professional, and social life. We believe in meritocracy - and meritocracy cannot function where the field is not level.

A Sensible Drug Policy

Progressive Caprica supports the controlled legalisation and regulation of cannabis and other low-risk substances. Prohibition has failed. It has enriched criminal networks, clogged our courts, and criminalised thousands of Capricans for choices that harmed no one but potentially themselves. Regulated legalisation, with appropriate age restrictions and public health oversight, is the rational policy.

For harder substances, the emphasis of the Caprican state shall shift decisively from punishment to rehabilitation. Addiction is a public health matter, not a criminal one. Treatment, support, and reintegration shall replace incarceration as the state's primary response.

Immigration: Controlled, Purposeful, Humane

Caprica is a nation that benefits from the contribution of those who choose it. Progressive Caprica supports a controlled immigration system built on contribution - academic talent, skilled labour, economic investment. We welcome those who come to build with us. We maintain the right of the republic to manage its borders with firmness and its intake with purpose.

Those who arrive on our shores shall be treated with the dignity owed to every human being. We are a republic of principle - and our principles do not end at the border.

Social Safety Net

Progressive Caprica does not believe in universal basic services as a policy model - we believe in targeted solidarity. No Caprican shall sleep on the street without access to shelter. No Caprican shall face a life-threatening or emergency medical situation without receiving care.

No Caprican in need of critical medication shall be denied it for want of means.

Homeless shelters shall be expanded across every region of Caprica.

Emergency and life-threatening healthcare is guaranteed to every person on Caprican soil. These are not generous gestures. They are the minimum requirements of a state that calls itself civilised.

Freedom of Marriage

Progressive Caprica believes that every type of marriage is legit, including polyamory. The Illiberals and conservatives have pushed to limit love by metrics but the humane position would be to accept that all love is love and no one has the right to limit it.

The family takes many forms in modern Caprica, and the law must reflect that with generosity. Progressive Caprica will reform parental legislation to give equal standing to all family structures, and will extend parental leave entitlements so that the burden of care is shared and fathers are empowered to be present from a child's earliest days.

IV. EDUCATION: THE FOUNDATION OF THE REPUBLIC

A republic that neglects the minds of its citizens does not deserve them.

Education is not a service we should provide reluctantly. We will not allow an accident of geography or family income to determine a child's intellectual destiny.

Public Education as a Public Good

Education at every level - from primary school through university - shall be a public institution, publicly funded, and universally accessible. Private schools may continue to operate and will be permitted to function as they see fit, within the law, provided they pay their full and fair share of taxes.

The Teaching Profession

We cannot build a great education system on the backs of underpaid teachers. Progressive Caprica will substantially raise teacher salaries, making the profession competitive with the private sector and reflective of the profound social responsibility it carries. We will launch a national programme to recruit, train, and retain outstanding educators from every region of Caprica, ensuring no community is left with second-rate instruction.

Higher Education and Research

The universities of Caprica shall be centres of genuine intellectual ambition - not credentialing factories. Progressive Caprica will invest significantly in research funding, university infrastructure, and academic independence. We believe in knowledge for its own sake, and in its application for the benefit of all.

THE CAPRICAN SCHOOL OF MERITOCRATIC DEVELOPMENT

This is Progressivr Caprica's most ambitious educational commitment - and the one we are most proud of.

Beginning at the secondary school level, high-performing students from every region of Caprica will be identified by dedicated academic counsellors embedded in their schools. These students - regardless of their family's wealth, their region's prestige, or their parents' connections - will be offered a place at the Caprican School of Meritocratic Development.

The CSMD is not a school. It is a republic within the republic. Its campuses are self-contained communities - residential, social, intellectual. Students live there. They study there. Private businesses - restaurants, cafes, shops - are invited to operate within these campuses, creating genuine economic and social life alongside the academic one.

The state provides student housing, basic necessities, and a performance-linked allowance - with a guaranteed minimum that can never fall below an established threshold, ensuring no student suffers material hardship for choosing academic excellence. The better a student performs, the more they receive - because excellence, in the Republic of Virtue, is rewarded.

The curriculum is demanding. We will not pretend otherwise. We expect many students to find the programme is not for them, and we honour their right to return to the standard system without stigma. The CSMD is not a punishment. It is an invitation to the hardest, most important work a young Caprican can do.

To support those who accept that invitation, comprehensive mental health services, wellbeing programmes, and therapeutic support are embedded throughout the CSMD experience - free of charge, without stigma, and integral to the programme's design. We ask our students to stretch to their limits. We will not abandon them when they do.

At the secondary level, students choose a pathway: Military, Scientific, or Political-Economic - or a combination of all three. Their education is tailored accordingly. Those who succeed through to doctoral level will be offered positions in Caprica's research centres, ministries, and armed forces - not because they come from the right family, but because they have earned it.

V. SCIENCE, RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT

Progressive Caprica is the party of science - unconditionally, unapologetically, and without reservation. We live in an age of accelerating discovery, where the nations that invest in knowledge will lead and those that do not will follow. Caprica will lead.

We commit to a research and development budget at a scale Caprica has not seen in living memory. State-of-the-art R&D centres will be established across every region of the republic - not concentrated in the capital, not reserved for the already-prosperous, but distributed as instruments of regional development and national ambition alike.

Nuclear energy is and shall remain part of Caprica's energy infrastructure. It is clean, it is reliable, and it is the rational choice. Beyond that, investment in renewables will naturally lower energy costs and viability in implementation, through research as well as economies of scale.

Progressive Caprica will continue to develop and maintain our nuclear and renewable capacity as part of a diversified, responsible, and forward-looking national energy policy.

Scientific freedom is a condition of scientific progress. Researchers in Caprican institutions will be free to pursue knowledge without political interference. Public funding for science is not patronage - it is investment. And like all our investments, it will be measured by results.

The R&D Tax Credits

Caprica's prosperity will be built in laboratories and workshops, not in rent-seeking and incumbency. Progressive Caprica will create a R&D tax credit, extending its reach to the small firms and start-ups where genuine innovation originates, while cutting the bureaucratic complexity that currently deters legitimate claimants.

VI. HEALTHCARE: A RIGHT, NOT A MARKET

No Caprican should fear that illness will bankrupt them. No Caprican should avoid a doctor because they cannot afford one. Healthcare is a right of citizenship - guaranteed, universal, and publicly administered.

The Public Health System

Progressive Caprica maintains and expands the public healthcare system as the primary provider of health services across Caprica. Every citizen, in every region, has access to quality care. The inequalities in health outcomes between Caprica's regions are not inevitable - they are the result of neglect, and they will be corrected.

Private Practice

Private clinics and healthcare providers may operate alongside the public system. Where they do, and where patients choose to use them, costs that are deemed life-threatening and emergency, for people who are not able to afford these costs, shall be covered within the public reimbursement framework. We have no objection to private medicine operating within the republic's healthcare system - provided it supplements, rather than supplants, public care.

Pharmaceutical Policy

The state shall negotiate directly with pharmaceutical companies on drug pricing. The days of Caprica paying whatever is demanded by international pharmaceutical interests are over.

Pricing must be reasonable - sustainable for the industry, and affordable for the state and for the citizen.

For those requiring specific medications who cannot afford them, a guaranteed access safety net will ensure that no Caprican goes without treatment for want of means.

VII. HOUSING & INFRASTRUCTURE

Every Caprican deserves a home. Not a guarantee of a specific home - but a market and a state that make home ownership and secure rental genuinely achievable. The current housing situation serves developers and speculators. Under Progressive Caprica, it will serve citizens.

Housing Supply and Quality

We reject rent control as a mechanism for affordable housing. Rent control does not create homes - it restricts the supply of them. Instead, the Progressives will liberalise planning and building regulations to dramatically increase the supply of new housing, driving down costs through availability. Quality standards and construction safety requirements will be stringently maintained - we build more, but we do not build worse.

Our proposed LVT changes will help the building-more approach even further. Creating a strong system for higher density housing construction projects to strive rather than to survive.

The Multi-Property Tax

Empty homes are a moral scandal in a republic that has people without shelter. Owners of three or more residential properties will face a progressive multi-property tax on their excess holdings.

The first and second home are untouched. The third is taxed. The fourth is taxed more. Each additional property above that threshold is taxed at an escalating rate - discouraging the hoarding of residential property as a financial instrument and returning homes to their purpose: being lived in.

Public Transport and the National Railway

Progressive Caprica believes in strong, expansive public transportation as a matter of social equality, regional cohesion, and environmental responsibility. We will build a high-speed rail network connecting every state capital in Caprica.

Beyond the inter-capital spine, we commit to rail and transit connections between rural communities and urban centres, ensuring that the accident of living outside a major city does not condemn citizens to isolation, dependency on private vehicles, or exclusion from economic opportunity.

VIII. MEDIA, INFORMATION & DIGITAL RIGHTS

A democracy that does not protect the information environment of its citizens is not a democracy - it is a system waiting to be manipulated. Progressive Caprica will act decisively to protect Capricans from monopolistic media control, foreign-directed disinformation, and the erosion of digital privacy.

Media Regulation and Plurality

No single private entity shall be permitted to own multiple media organisations simultaneously. A free press requires a plural press. Media consolidation in the hands of a few owners is not pluralism - it is the illusion of it. Progressive Caprica will legislate for genuine media plurality, ensuring that Capricans have access to a genuinely diverse range of perspectives and voices.

Combating Disinformation

We will establish dedicated social media accounts tasked with identifying and publicly correcting disinformation. These units will operate transparently, with clearly published methodologies and independent oversight. Their weapon against false information is a simple one: verified fact. We do not silence - we correct.

Digital Privacy

The personal data of Caprican citizens is not a commodity. Progressive Caprica will implement strong data privacy protections, comparable to the highest international standards, governing the collection, storage, and use of personal information by private entities. Citizens shall have the right to know what data is held about them and the right to have it deleted.

IX. FOREIGN POLICY & NATIONAL DEFENCE

Caprica is not a country of isolation. Our prosperity, our security, and our values are bound up with the world beyond our borders - and we will conduct ourselves in that world with clarity of purpose and consistency of principle.

The Columbian Union

Progressive Caprica is unambiguously committed to Caprica's membership in and engagement with the Columbian Union.

The CU represents the most significant framework for collective prosperity, security, and democratic values available to us. We will be active, constructive, and principled partners within it - working to shape it in accordance with Caprican interests and Caprican values, not merely accepting what is decided without us.

We will pursue deeper Columbian integration, champion federalist reform of Columbian institutions, and ensure Caprica is never a passive observer but an active architect of our continent's future.

National Defence

We maintain a strong, professional, and well-equipped national defence force. Caprica's military is proportional to our size and regional context - credible, capable, and respected. We will ensure our armed forces are properly funded, properly equipped, and properly supported - because the men and women who serve Caprica deserve nothing less.

The military serves the republic. It is an institution of the citizens of Caprica, not of any government. Progressive Caprica will maintain clear civil oversight of military affairs while ensuring our commanders have the resources and authority to do their jobs.

Trade Policy

Progressive Caprica supports free and open trade as the engine of Caprican prosperity. We will pursue favourable trade relationships across the globe - with one condition. Nations that represent a strategic rival or security threat to Caprica will not receive the benefits of open trade with us. Commerce is not value-neutral, and Caprican prosperity cannot be built on arrangements that undermine our security or compromise our sovereignty.

X. SUSTAINABILITY, GREEN ENERGY, & ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

The health of our shared world is not a concern that Caprica can stay out of. The ideals of green energy, sustainability, and environmental protection are all necessary if one is interested in the public health and the common good.

Carbon Pricing

The current carbon tax is a promising mechanism to put a price on carbon, but what if we can look beyond that?

Progressive Caprica believes that by reforming the carbon tax into a cap-and-permit system, we can retain the benefits of a carbon tax while also introducing a forward-looking hard cap on emissions. A permit system will distribute tradable allowances on emissions, which lets the Caprican government also set a hard limit on allowed emissions.

To ensure that the economic dynamism of tradable allowances do not counteract the goal of reducing emissions, a hard regulatory price floor will be set to cancel allowances if the price of permits fall below a set threshold.

We can utilize smart economic policy to drive a green future.

Green Banking

Progressive Caprica supports a national green investment bank offering preferential collateral treatment for green bonds. De-risking private investment in new green technology will ensure that we lay the foundation for necessary investment in Caprica's future energy infrastructure.

Lower risk weights for green assets and green quantitative easing alongside intelligent targeted investment, through public procurement mandates, advanced market commitments, and large-scale public investment, will ensure that Caprican infrastructure is built in service of public health instead of in service of profit.

We can introduce policy levers that properly address the environmental issues that face us, but first we must have an understanding of those issues. From every level of governance regarding sustainability, we must have a wide range of professionals in different sectors in order to ascertain a proper holistic understanding of the impacts of emissions.

CONCLUSION: THE REPUBLIC WE CHOOSE TO BUILD

The Republic of Virtue is not an inheritance. It is a choice - one that must be made anew by every generation, in every election, in every act of public life. We cannot be handed a virtuous republic. We must build it, maintain it, and defend it against those who would hollow it out for private gain.

Progressive Caprica offers Caprica not a perfect programme but an honest one. We have told you what we believe, what we will do, and what we will not do. We have told you who we are for - the worker, the thinker, the soldier, the region, the citizen - and who we are against: the oligarch, the demagogue, the foreign lobby, and the speculator who treats Caprica as a market rather than a home.

We stand for the Third Republic. We stand for Caprica. We stand, above all, for the citizen who has been told too many times that the system is not for them.

- Kostas Pastry

It is for them. And under the Progressives, it will show.

